



I bring good cheer

The sight of me will make you feel happy and festive as I am so closely associated with Christmas, family, and giving. My red color evokes positive emotions of love and enjoyment and feelings of comfort and warmth, putting you in a relaxed and tranquil mood over the winter months.



I need help to stay looking my best

It may be difficult to get my red bracts to color for Christmas year after year, but to encourage me to perform my best, put me in a dark room with no artificial light after 12 hours of daylight every day for 10 weeks from November. And if you can't, I still make a pretty amazing green houseplant.



Be mindful of me

Cold blasts of air can hurt me, so please don't put me near a door or window that will be opened during the winter. When you're taking me home from the store, lightly cover me so I don't catch a chill and freeze.



Get to know me

The Aztecs originally named me *cuetlaxochitl*, meaning "flower that withers," and also used the red pigment of my bracts to dye fabrics. Many mistake my brightly colored leaves for flowers, but in fact they are bracts (modified leaves). I do have small yellow flowers, but they are not as beautiful as my bracts.



BE AWARE: I can be harmful if eaten, so keep me away from young children and pets.